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Tharifith

Riffian Language Course

LESSON 12

Common Verbs

A Comprehensive Guide for Beginners Created by LEARN THARIFITH

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A Comprehensive Guide to Riffian Berber

Essential Verbs for Everyday Communication

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1. Introduction to Common Verbs

Building on the conjugation patterns learned in the previous lessons, this lesson introduces a comprehensive collection of the most frequently used verbs in Tharifith. These verbs form the backbone of everyday communication, enabling you to express a wide range of actions, states, and relationships. By mastering these common verbs, you will significantly expand your ability to participate in conversations, tell stories, ask questions, and express your thoughts and needs in Tharifith. Each verb is presented with its basic form, conjugation patterns, and examples of usage in context.

The verbs in this lesson are organized by semantic categories to facilitate learning and memorization. Grouping verbs by meaning helps create mental associations that make vocabulary acquisition more efficient. For each category, we present the most essential verbs first, followed by less common but still important vocabulary. The conjugation of each verb follows the patterns established in previous lessons, the aorist for present and future actions, the preterite for past actions, and the imperative for commands. As you study these verbs, pay attention to any irregularities in their conjugation and practice using them in complete sentences.

Understanding how these common verbs work in context is crucial for developing fluency. Many Tharifith verbs have nuances that differ from their English equivalents, and some concepts are expressed differently in the two languages. For example, the verb 'iri' (to be) is often omitted entirely in equational sentences, and possession is expressed using prepositional phrases rather than a verb 'to have.' These structural differences reflect the unique worldview encoded in the Tharifith language and highlight the importance of learning verbs in their cultural and grammatical context.

2. Verbs of Motion and Movement

Verbs of motion are among the most frequently used words in any language, and Tharifith is no exception. These verbs describe the fundamental actions of going, coming, arriving, and moving in various ways. The mountainous terrain of the Rif region has influenced the development of a rich vocabulary for movement, with specific verbs for different types of motion. Understanding these verbs is essential for giving and understanding directions, describing travel, and narrating events involving movement.

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2.1 Basic Motion Verbs

Verb	Meaning	Type
ruḥ	to go	regular
ased	to come	irregular
aweḍh	to arrive/reach	irregular
kkar	to stand up/ get up	irregular
Dhwer	to return	regular
Ffegh	to go out/exit	regular
adhef	to enter	regular
Nduw	to climb	regular
hwa	to descend/go down	regular
Ugur / uyar	to walk	regular

2.2 Conjugation Examples

Below are full conjugations for the most important motion verbs. Some are irregular and requires special attention.

Person	ruḥ (go)	ased (come)	aweḍh (arrive)
3rd m. sing. aorist	ad i-ruḥ	ad i-as	ad i-aweḍh
3rd m. sing. pret.	i-ruḥ	i-usid	i-aweḍh
3rd f. sing. pret.	th-ruḥ	at-as	th-weḍh
1st sing. pret.	ruḥ-gh	Usi-gh-d	awḍhe-gh
3rd pl. pret.	ruḥ-n	usind	awḍhe-n

2.3 Motion Verbs in Context

Tharifith	English
i-ruḥ ghar ssuq	he went to the market
ad i-dwer ghar thaddarth	he will come home
i-weḍh ghar dchar	he arrived at the village
th-kkar zik	she got up early
ad n-fegh thiwcha	we will go out tomorrow
udhf-gh ghar ukham	I entered the room

3. Verbs of Perception and Cognition

Verbs of perception and cognition describe how we experience and understand the world around us. These verbs are essential for expressing what we see, hear, know, think, and feel. In Tharifith, as in many languages, these verbs often have both literal and metaphorical uses—'to see' can mean both visual perception and thinking, while 'to hear' can mean both auditory perception and heeding advice. Mastering these verbs will greatly enhance your ability to share experiences and express your thoughts and opinions.

3.1 Perception Verbs

Verb	Meaning	Additional Meanings
ẓer	to see	to understand, to watch
S’ḥess /senneth	to hear	to listen, to obey
ḥadha	to touch	to perceive
Qarrb	to approach	to get close
baâdh	to go away	To get away
Khza / nadhor	to look at	to examine
Arja	to dream	-

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3.2 Cognition Verbs

Verb	Meaning	Usage Notes
ssen	to know	regular
ttu	to forget	regular
aâqer	to remember	use your mind
Kharres/ fekkar	to think	regular
amen	to believe	spiritual & religious
fhem	to understand	regular
rmedh	to learn	to study

3.3 Perception and Cognition in Context

Tharifith	English
ur i-ssen chi/cha	he doesn't know
ad ak-fehmegh	I will understand you
i-ẓra aghrum	he saw the bread
ur i-aâqer chi/cha i-ttu	He doesn’t remember he forgot
i-fekkar-d mmis	he remembered his son
i-tfekka dheghya/ s thazra	he thinks so fast
shess-d ghari ! Senthai-d !	listen to me!

4. Verbs of Communication

Communication is at the heart of human interaction, and Tharifith has a rich vocabulary for describing various forms of verbal and non-verbal communication. These verbs are essential for describing conversations, asking questions, giving information, and expressing intentions. The cultural context of communication in the Rif region emphasizes respect, hospitality, and

appropriate forms of address, which influence how these verbs are used in different social situations. Understanding the nuances of communication verbs will help you participate more effectively in Tharifith conversations.

4.1 Speaking and Saying

Verb	Meaning	Notes
ini	to say	irregular, very common
siwer	to speak	to talk
Ghennej / ghenna	to sing	regular use
Seqsa / ttar	to ask	to ask for
arr	to respond	to give back
Nka	to deny	-

4.2 Asking and Answering

Verb	Meaning	Usage
seqsa	to ask	to inquire
Jaweb / arr	to answer	to reply
âawdhas	to say again	to repeat
sefhem	to explain	to make understand
âarem	to inform	to inform
sqarr	to admit	-
qber	to accept	to be satisfied

4.3 Communication Verbs in Context

Tharifith	English
i-nnay-d kulchi/ marra	he told me everything
ur i-ssiwir-chi/cha s thrifith	he doesn't speak Tharifith
Sseqsigh-t	I asked her
ad arregh khak	I will answer you
inay-d!	tell me!
Ssiwergh ak-dh babak	I talked with my father
Raghas-d i yemmak !	call your mother!

5. Verbs of Daily Activities

The verbs in this section describe the routine activities that make up daily life in the Rif region. Many of these verbs reflect traditional practices and the agricultural lifestyle that characterizes rural Riffian communities. From cooking and eating to working and resting, these verbs are indispensable for describing everyday experiences. Learning these verbs will enable you to talk about your daily routine, ask about others' activities, and understand descriptions of Riffian daily life.

5.1 Eating and Drinking

Verb	Meaning	Notes
ech	to eat	basic verb
swu	to drink	basic verb
kemmer	to finish (eating)	basic verb
sewjedh	to prepare	-
khdhem	to work	general verb
snenn	to cook	to prepare food

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5.2 Household and Work Activities

Verb	Meaning	Context
ssek	to sweep	household
siredh/Siadh	to wash	general cleaning
sebben	to wash clothes	laundry
kheyedh	to sew	clothing
ẓẓu	to plant	agriculture
krez / chaz	to plow	farming
mjar	to harvest	agriculture
ẓẓadj	to pray	religious
ghar	to read	education
ari	to write	education

5.3 Rest and Sleep

Verb	Meaning	Notes
ttes	to sleep	basic verb
Skutha /atah	to rest	to take a break
kkar	to wake up	same as 'get up'
zzer	to lie down	to fall
qqim	to sit /stay/remain	basic verb

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5.4 Daily Activities in Context

Tharifith	English
ad chegh amensi/ ad munswegh	I will eat dinner
i-sgha-d aghrum	he bought the bread
t-siredh / syadh arrodh nnes	she washed her clothes
i-kheddem deg/di igar	he works in the field
ittes zik	he slept early
qqim-gh di thaddarth	I stayed home

6. Modal and Auxiliary Verbs

Modal verbs express concepts like ability, necessity, desire, and permission. In Tharifith, many modal concepts are expressed through specific verbs or verb constructions rather than separate auxiliary verbs as in English. The particle 'ad' plays a crucial role in many modal constructions, and several verbs can function modally only when combined with other verbs. Understanding these constructions will allow you to express nuanced meanings and expand your communicative range in Tharifith.

6.1 Ability and Possibility

Verb	Meaning	Usage
I-zmar	to be able	can/could
Netta i-zmar ad- isiwer	He is able to speak	-
Nettath th-zmar ad t-as	She might come	Might / chance that

Examples of ability constructions:

Tharifith	English
zmar-gh ad raḥegh	I can go
ur i-zmir chi/cha ad i-as	he cannot come
Ad t-zemr-dh ad t-zeredh	you will be able to see it

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6.2 Necessity and Obligation

Verb/Expression	Meaning
iḥwa	it is necessary
itkhessa	it must/need to
iɣella	it is needed
azrail	necessary, urgent
Tharifith	**English**
iḥwa ad ruḥeɣ	I must go
iɣella waman	water is needed
sseɣ ad xeddeɣ	I need to work

6.3 Desire and Intention

Verb	Meaning	Notes
khes	to want	most common
ssitem	to want/wish	alternative
arzu	to seek / to intend	to plan
Tharifith	**English**	
ikhes ad i-as	he wants to come	
rzzugh ad t-ẓregh/ t-zagh	I want to see her	

7. Verbs with Prepositions

Many Tharifith verbs are followed by specific prepositions that complete their meaning. These verb-preposition combinations, similar to English phrasal verbs, must be learned as fixed expressions because the preposition often cannot be predicted from the verb's meaning alone. The preposition 'akedh/ dh' (with/ in addition to), 's' (with/the way it is done), 'ghar' (to/towards), 'dhi/gi' (in/at),"i" (to), and "zi" (from) are among the most common in these

constructions. Mastering these combinations will significantly improve your ability to express complex relationships and actions in Tharifith.

7.1 Common Verb-Preposition Combinations

Verb + Prep	Meaning
Nech guregh akedh…	I walk with…
ẓer d	to tell/inform
Nech siwregh akedh…	I had a call with…
Nech nighas i …	I said to…
Nech ruḥegh ghar	I went to…
Nech dureghd zi…	I came back from…
Nech siwregh s …	I talked with…
Nich fghegh zi…	I went out from…

7.2 Prepositions in Context

Tharifith	English
Nech siwr-gh akedh yemma	I talked with my mother
Inayi-d min yemsan	tell me what happened
ini-as ad i-dwer	tell him to come
i-ruḥ ghar th'hanut	go to the market
Nech udef-gh ghar thaddarth	I entered the house
Netta yeffegh zi dchar	he left the village

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8. Practice Exercises

The following exercises will help you practice and reinforce the common verbs presented in this lesson. Work through each exercise carefully, referring back to the vocabulary tables as needed. Regular practice with these verbs will help them become automatic in your speech.

Exercise 1: Verb Identification

Match the Tharifith verbs with their English meanings.

1. aweḍh_____ a. To understand (Perception/Cognition)
2. fhem _____ b. To be able to / Can (Modal)
3. siwer _____ c. To arrive / reach (Motion)
4. ttes _____ d. To speak (Communication)
5. ẓẓu _____ e. To sleep (Daily Activities)
6. zmar _____ f. To plant (Daily Activities)

Exercise 2: Fill in the Blanks (Contextual)

Fill in the blanks with the most appropriate verb from the lesson in its correct form. (Hint: Look at Section 2.3, 3.3, and 5.4 for clues).

1. Th-ruḥ ghar ssuq. (He _____ to the market).
2. i-_____ aghrum. (He saw the bread).
3. ad chegh amensi. (I will _____ dinner).
4. i-kheddem deg/di igar. (He _____ in the field).
5. ur i-ssen chi/cha. (He doesn't _____).

Exercise 3: Irregular Conjugation (Past Tense / Preterite)

The lesson highlights that some motion verbs are irregular in the past tense. Using the table in Section 2.2, conjugate the following verbs for the requested persons.

- ased (to come) -> 1st person singular (I came): _____
- ruḥ (to go) -> 3rd person feminine singular (She went): _____
- aweḍh (to arrive) -> 3rd person plural (They arrived): _____

Exercise 4: Modal Verbs & The 'ad' Particle

Translate the following sentences into English using the Modal Verbs section (Section 6). Pay close attention to the words: zmar, iḥwa, and khes.

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1. zmar-gh ad raḥegh
2. ur i-zmir chi/cha ad i-as
3. itkhessa ad aruḥegh
4. rzzugh ad t-ẓragh

Exercise 5: Verb + Preposition Combinations

In Tharifith, verbs must be paired with the correct preposition. Choose the correct preposition from the box to complete the sentences. **Box: ghar | zi | akedh | d**

1. Nech siwr-gh _____ yemma. (I talked with my mother)
2. i-ruḥ _____ th'hanut. (Go to the market)
3. Netta yeffegh _____ dchar. (He left the village)
4. ẓer _____ (to tell/inform)

Exercise 6: Translate to Tarifit

Using only the vocabulary provided in the lesson, translate these English sentences into Tarifit.

1. Listen to me! (Use the imperative from Section 3.3)
2. She washed her clothes. (Use Section 5.4)
3. I entered the house. (Use Section 2.3)
4. I need to work. (Use Section 6.2)
5. He doesn't speak Tharifith. (Use Section 4.3)

10. Answer Key

Ex 1: 1-C, 2-A, 3-D, 4-E, 5-F, 6-B

Ex 2: 1. i-ruḥ, 2. ẓra, 3. ech (or munswegh), 4. kheddem, 5. ssen

Ex 3: 1. usighd, 2. th-ruḥ, 3. awḍe-n

Ex 4: 1. I can go, 2. He cannot come, 3. I must go, 4. I want to see her.

Ex 5: 1. akedh, 2. ghar, 3. zi, 4. d

Ex 6: 1. shess-d ghari ! (or Senthai-d!), 2. t-siredh / t-syadh arrodh nnes, 3. udef-gh ghar ukham (or thaddarth), 4. Itkhessa ad khedmegh, 5. ur i-ssiwir-chi/cha s thrifith.

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11. Lesson Summary

In this lesson, you have significantly expanded your Tharifith vocabulary by learning a comprehensive collection of common verbs organized by semantic categories. The verbs of motion enable you to describe movement and travel; verbs of perception and cognition allow you to express sensory experiences and mental processes; verbs of communication facilitate describing conversations and exchanging information; and verbs of daily help you discuss routine actions and everyday life.

The modal constructions using 'zmar' (can), 'itkhessa' (must), and 'irezzu' (want) combined with the particle 'ad' enable you to express ability, necessity, and desire. The verb-preposition combinations must be memorized as fixed expressions. Finally, the idiomatic expressions presented in this lesson offer insight into Riffian culture and provide you with more natural and authentic ways to express yourself in Tharifith.

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